



PHYSICAL STAMINA

Time to Relax and Recharge

Time to Relax and Recharge

83%

of all respondents find it hard to
mentally relax and recharge

67%

% respondents with **high levels**
of resilience who find it hard to
relax and recharge

91%

% respondents with **average
levels** of resilience who find it
hard to relax and recharge

100%

% respondents with **low levels**
of resilience who find it hard to
relax and recharge

Time to Relax and Recharge

Common reasons people find it difficult to relax and recharge



Constant Connectivity

The pressure to stay connected through smartphones, social media and digital devices makes it hard to disconnect.



Busy Lifestyles

Work commitments, family responsibilities, and social engagements, leave little time for rest and relaxation.



Stress and Anxiety

Difficult to switch off from intrusive thoughts and worries such as work deadlines, financial pressures, and relationship issues.



Overstimulation

Bright lights, loud noises, information overload and multitasking can overwhelm our nervous system making it hard to unwind.



Guilt and Expectations

Societal expectations and cultural norms around busyness and productivity can create pressure on ourselves to be constantly on the go.



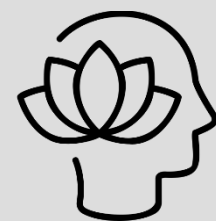
The Impact of an Inability to Relax and Recharge

An inability to relax and recharge can have significant negative impacts on an individual's physical, mental and emotional well-being, and their resilience



Physical Health

Chronic stress and lack of relaxation can contribute to health issues, such as high blood pressure, cardiovascular disease, weakened immune function, and muscle tension.



Mental Health

Persistent stress and an inability to unwind can exacerbate mental health conditions such as anxiety, depression, and mood disorders.



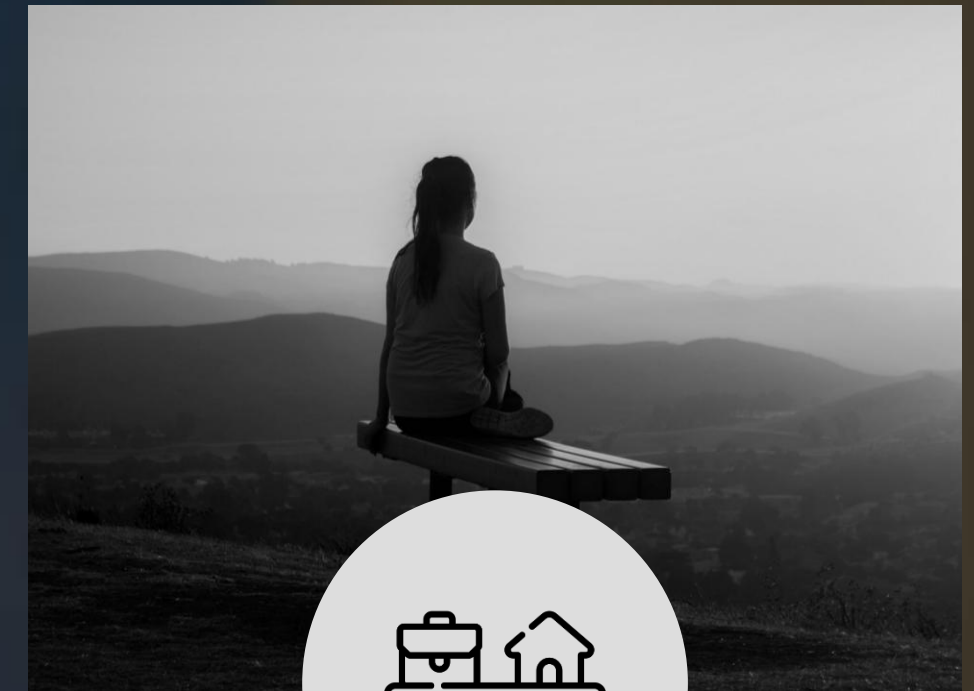
Relationships

The inability to relax and recharge can strain interpersonal relationships, as individuals may be more irritable, withdrawn, or emotionally unavailable.



Productivity and Performance

Lack of opportunities for relaxation and rejuvenation, results in diminished cognitive function, creativity, and problem-solving abilities.



Quality of Life

Without moments of rest and leisure, life may feel like an endless cycle of stress and exhaustion, devoid of joy and fulfilment.

What is Mindfulness?

“Mindfulness is a mental practice of intentionally focusing attention on the present moment with an attitude of openness, curiosity, and non-judgement”



Mindfulness is about paying attention to what's happening right now, without thinking about the past or worrying about the future.



Mindfulness is like hitting pause on your busy thoughts and just noticing what's going on in the present moment.



Mindfulness encourages us to fully engage with our experiences, whether they are pleasant, unpleasant, or neutral, with an attitude of acceptance and openness.



Mindfulness is about being fully present and aware of what you're doing and how you're feeling, without judging yourself or the situation.



Mindfulness is like giving yourself permission to slow down, take a deep breath, and just be.

The Components of Mindfulness



Meditation

Involves the cultivation of a focused and non-judgmental awareness of the present moment.

Various techniques including Focused Attention meditation, breath awareness, body scan meditation, loving-kindness meditation, mindful walking and visualisation meditation.



Yoga

A physical and spiritual practice that integrates breath control, meditation, and body postures to promote physical strength, flexibility, and inner peace.



Breathing

Conscious breathing is a simple yet powerful technique that can be practiced anywhere, anytime.

By bringing attention to the breath, we anchor ourselves in the present moment, calming the mind and body.



Walks in Nature

Immersing ourselves in nature is a potent form of mindfulness practice.

Spending time in nature allows us to reconnect with the natural world and experience a sense of awe and wonder.

The Benefits of Mindfulness



Reduced Stress

Mindfulness reduces stress levels by promoting relaxation and helping individuals develop a healthier response to stressors.



Improved Mental Health

Regular mindfulness practice can alleviate symptoms of anxiety, depression, and other mental health conditions through emotional regulation and resilience.



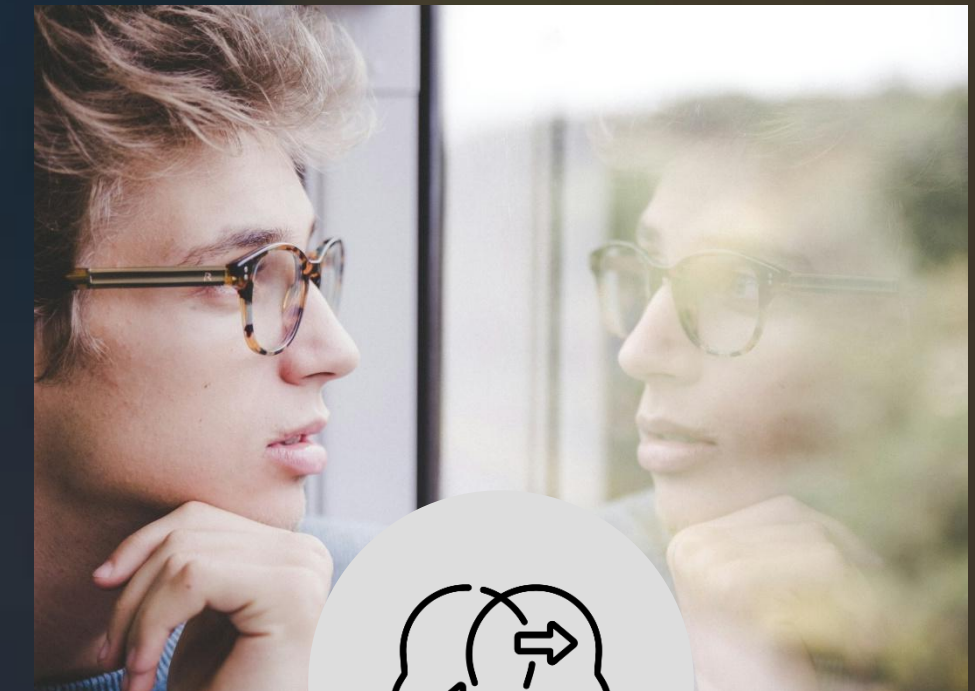
Healthy Relationships

Mindfulness helps us become more attuned to our own emotions and those of others, fostering empathy, compassion and deeper connections in our relationships.



Enhanced Focus & Concentration

By training the mind to focus on the present moment, mindfulness enhances concentration and cognitive performance.



Increased Self-Awareness

Enabling individuals to recognize patterns of thought and behaviour, leading to greater self-understanding and personal growth.

Improving Our Ability to Relax and Recharge – Best Practice



Mindfulness & Meditation

Practice mindfulness or meditation regularly



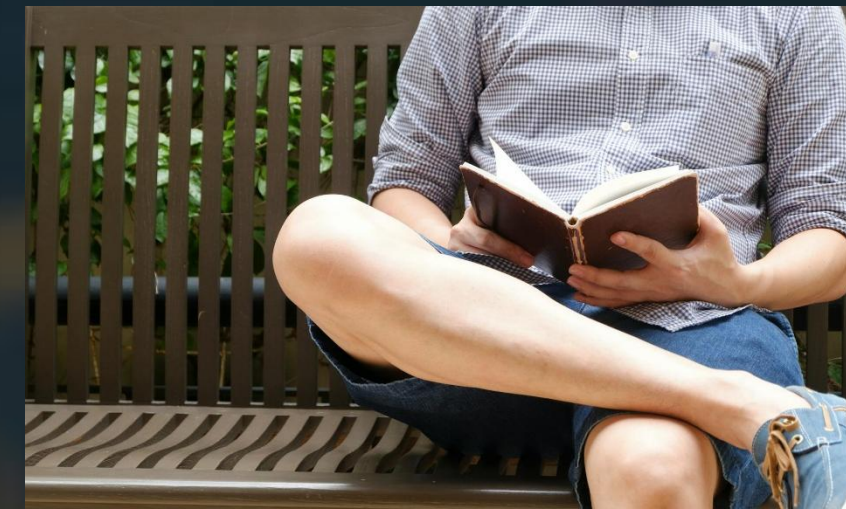
Deep Breathing Exercises

Incorporate deep breathing exercises into your daily routine



Regular Exercise

Engage in regular physical activity, such as walking, yoga, or swimming



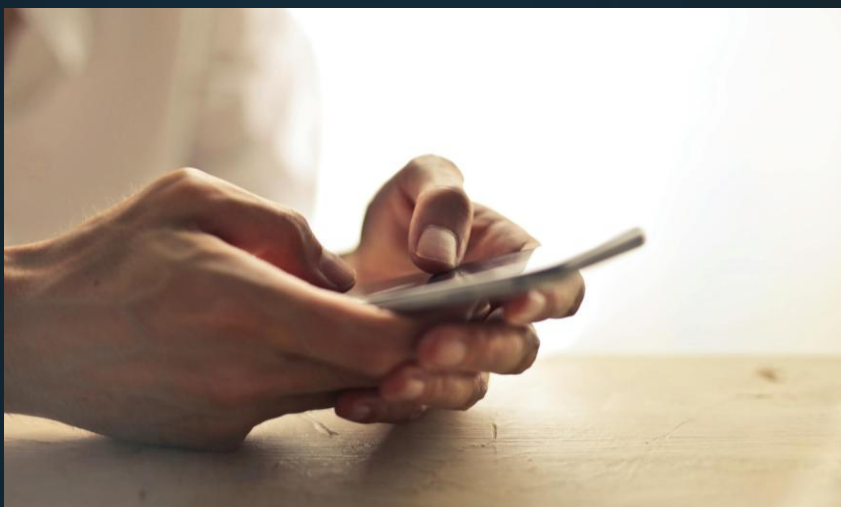
Create a Relaxation Routine

That includes activities you enjoy, such as reading or listening to music



Limit Screen Time

Reduce your screen time, especially before bedtime



Set Boundaries

Say no to commitments that drain your energy. Turn off notifications on evenings and weekends



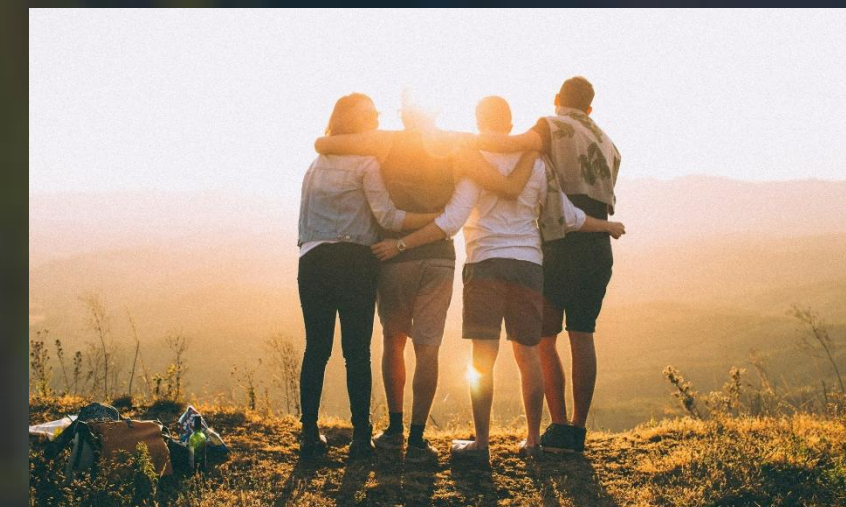
Get Enough Sleep

Prioritize sleep and aim for 7-9 hours of quality sleep each night. Limit caffeine and alcohol in the hours leading up to bedtime



Connect with Nature

Spend time outdoors and connect with nature



Socialise & Seek Support

Maintain strong social connections, seek support from friends and family



Practice Gratitude

Take time each day to reflect on things you're grateful for

Mindfulness in Practice

The Science Behind Breathing Techniques



Breathing techniques are fundamental in mindfulness practices due to their immediate impact on the body's stress response system;



Activates The Parasympathetic System

Deep, controlled breathing stimulates the vagus nerve, which activates the parasympathetic nervous system, responsible for the body's "rest and digest" response.



Improvement in Heart Rate Variability

Diaphragmatic breathing improves HRV, boosting cardiovascular health and stress resilience.



Reduction of Stress Hormones

Deep breathing triggers the release of endorphins which are natural painkillers and mood elevators, it also decreases the production of stress hormones such as cortisol and adrenaline.



Enhanced Cognitive Function

Mindful breathing improves cognitive functions such as attention, concentration and decision-making.



Balancing Oxygen and Carbon Dioxide

Breathing techniques optimize oxygen and carbon dioxide balance in the bloodstream, promoting relaxation and physiological stability.



Reduction in Inflammation

Chronic stress is associated with increased inflammation in the body, mindful breathing has been shown to decrease inflammatory markers, promoting overall health.



Mind-Body Connection

Mindful breathing fosters a deeper connection between the mind and body.



Support for Mental Health

Mindful breathing techniques are commonly used for various mental health conditions, such as anxiety, depression, and PTSD, helping individuals develop coping skills and regulate emotions.